Running Review Doc for Math 128A

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Contents

This document gives a running review of our Math 128A course, taught in Spring 2026 by Professor Ryan A. Hass using Kincaid and Cheney's book. This review is not comprehensive, and is just to give an overview of the topics.

1 Week 7: (Current) Matrix Norms (4.4) and...

2 Week 6.5: Midterm Review

The midterm covers chapters 1-3, so the calculus review, floating point numbers and the involved error, and root finding techniques. This whole document is a review document, bit here are some problems pulled from the text that I will use as practice during our review session in discussion.

1.) State Taylor's theorem with Lagrange Error. How does the Taylor polynomial approximate the function in big and little O notation?
1.1) Compute $ln(1.5)$ with accuracy at least 1/10 (you can write a sum and not evaluate it).
1.2) Show $1 + x \leq e^x$ for all x.

2.) What is the larges k so $\arctan(x) = x + O(x^k)$.
2.1) Is it true that $\frac{1}{n\ln(n)} = o(1/n)$
2.2) Let $a_n \to 0$ and $\lambda > 1$. Show $\sum_{k=0}^{n} a_k \lambda^k = o(\lambda^n)$.

3.) Let $x = 2^{12} + 2^{-12}$. Find a machine number representation x^* for x. What is the relative error between x and x^*?
3.1) If we compute the product of 3 numbers x_1, x_2, x_3 under floating point arithmetic, what is the maximum relative error between $fl(x_1x_2x_3)$ and $x_1x_2x_3$?
3.2) Let $n\epsilon < 0.01$. Find an upper bound for $(1 + \epsilon)^n - 1$ (not floating point!). One bound is 0.01006.

3 Week 6: Gaussian Elimination (4.3)

Linear algebra is extremely important to numerical problems. In last week's material, we went into a whole section on breaking down matrices via several factorizations just to make solving them easier in special cases. How can we compute these factorizations easily? We use a similar process to row reduction, but make the choices more consistent so that we can automate the process. Our goal will be Doolittle's factorization.

Let $A \in M(n)$. To perform Gaussian elimination on A, we perform a sequence of $n - 1$ steps resulting in a sequence of matrices $A = A^{(1)} \to ... \to A^{(n)}$ where the fimal matrix is upper triangular. We will have

$$A^{(k)} = \begin{bmatrix} U^{(k-1)} & B^{(k)} \\ 0 & C^{(k)} \end{bmatrix}$$

where $U^{(k-1)}$ is upper triangular. In other words, we perform row reduction sequentially so that the rows above the row in the step of interest remain unchanged. How is this possible? In general, it may not be, and this is where our previous theorems on LU factorization make more sense. Recall that, if a matrix has nonsingular principal minors, it has a LU factorization.

The algorithm proceeds as follows. Assume we have matrix $A^{(k)} = (a^k_{i,j})$ and want to form $A^{(k+1)}$. For the first k rows of $A^{(k)}$, we leave them be. Next, if i and j are both at least $k+1$, we reset values by subtracting off multiples of the pivot rows above:

$$a^{k+1}_{i,j} = a^k_{i,j} - \left(a^k_{i,k}/a^k_{k,k}\right) a^k_{k,j}$$

the remaining entries are all zeroes. For example, on the matrix

$$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & -2 & 2 \\ 12 & -8 & 6 \\ 3 & -13 & 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

we perform the iteration

$$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & -2 & 2 \\ 12 & -8 & 6 \\ 3 & -13 & 9 \end{bmatrix} \to \begin{bmatrix} 6 & -2 & 2 \\ 0 & -4 & 2 \\ 0 & -12 & 8 \end{bmatrix} \to \begin{bmatrix} 6 & -2 & 2 \\ 0 & -4 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

If all the pivots $a^k_{k,k}$ of this process are nonzero, then this produces $U = A^{(n)}$ and we collect the row operations for L:

$$l_{i,k} = \begin{cases} a^k_{i,k}/a^k_{k,k} & i \geq k+1 \\ 1 & i = k \\ 0 & i \leq k-1 \end{cases}$$

When doing this by hand, it's easier to just keep track of the multipliers you used for each step (for the above, $L = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 & 0 \\ 1/2 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$)To prove this statement, check that for L and U formed this way, $LU = A$. This amounts to chasing definitions.

This algorithm is great when it applies, but because it assumes the matrix has good structure, we should also try to form an algorithm that can address zeroes in the pivots as well as floating point and rounding issues that arise from having small pivots (you should be able to explain why small pivots can be an issue, perhaps using the example $\begin{bmatrix} \epsilon & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$). We call this process pivoting. You already know this process from using row reduction to get row echelon form, or perhaps reduced row echelon form to account for large pivots. In that case, we actually swap the rows, but here we will not swap them but still treat them as such and keep track of what permutation needs to be done to get an upper triangular matrix.

Our first algorithm for this process is full pivoting. We start with a square matrix $A \in M(n)$. In the first column, we find the index i so $|a_{i,1}| = \max_{1 \leq k \leq n} |a_{k,1}|$. Set $p_1 = 1$, and record the first column of the permutation matrix P as e_{p_1}. We set this to be our pivot row, and use row reduction as in Gaussian elimination to clear the first column of all entries other than $a_{p_1,1}$ via row reduction. When we repeat this process on the next column, we exclude $a_{p_1,2}$ from our consideration, but otherwise complete the same process. Doing this n times returns $A^{(n)}$ and P, so $PA = LU$ where $U = PA^{(n)}$, and L again tracks our progress.

[Example to be added here]

A second algorithm for the same process is scaled pivoting. First, we start with a square matrix $A \in M(n)$. To find the "large pivots", compute the scales $s_i = \max_{1 \leq k \leq n}\{|a_{i,k}|\}$ for $i = 1, ..., n$ and select the first pivot row $A_{p_1}^{(1)}$ where $|a_{p_1,1}|/s_{p_1} \geq |a_{i,1}|/s_1$ (where we at least reach the maximum relative size for the first column). We use this row to reduce the others, and log the number p_1 so the first column of our permutation matrix is e_{p_1}. Next, we repeat throughout the rest of the columns, where we again exclude the pivot row from our maximum choices as in the last algorithm. Scaled pivoting is competitive with full pivoting experimentally.

There is a third algorithm in the book that we will not focus on called complete pivoting. When the previous processes move forward th column k, they each consider $n - k + 1$ elements in the column to make pivot choices (n elements minus the previous pivot rows). Complete pivoting instead considers the $(n-k+1)^2$ elements of the submatrix formed by excluding previous pivot rows and columns, then picks either a pivot row or column.

Let the resulting permutation matrix be P, and this solve $PA = LU$. When we now go to solve $Ax = b$, we perform this process and have $PAx = Pb$, giving $LUx = Pb$. Updating $y = Pb$, we solve $Lz = y$ then $Ux = z$ to find x.

There are some cases where we may safely used Gaussian Elimination as opposed to one of these pivoting algorithms. A matrix is called diagonally dominant if

$$|a_{i,i}| > \sum_{\substack{j=1 \\ j \neq i}}^{n} |a_{i,j}|$$

for all $1 \leq i \leq n$. Gaussian elimination without pivoting preserves the diagonal dominance of a matrix, and so by our previous discussion it gives and LU factorization where U is diagonally dominant. As U is upper triangular, this implies it has nonzero diagonal entries and that the original A was also nonsingular. Applying full or scaled row pivoting to a diagonally dominant matrix will also be the exact same process to Gaussian elimination, so this is really the special case which amounts to tracking that choice of pivots.

4 Week 5: Computing roots of polynomials (3.5), Matrix Algebra and Factorizations (4.1-4.2)

4.1 Polynomial Roots

Due to the work of Gauss, we know that a degree n polynomial has n complex roots (the Fundamental Theorem of algebra paired with polynomial division). Following our trend on root finding to replace various proceeses like rational roots, we would like to find an efficient method of computing these roots. We start with localization theorems, which tell us a range of where the roots may lie. Consider a polynomial $p(x) = a_n z^n + a_{n-1} z^{n-1} + ... + a_0$.

Localization Theorem All the roots of $p(x)$ written as above lie in $B(0, \rho) \subset \mathbb{C}$ where $\rho = 1 + |a_n|^{-1} \max_{0 \leq k \leq n} |a_k|$.

Proof: Let $c = \max_{0 \leq k \leq n} |a_k|$. The case $c = 0$ is immediate, so assume $c > 0$ and $\rho > 1$. For $|z| \geq \rho$, (use the reverse triangle inequality and geometric sums).

$$|p(z)| \geq |a_n z^n| - c \sum_{k=1}^{n-1} |z|^k > |a_n z^n| - c|z|^n (|z| - 1)^{-1} \geq |a_n z^n|(1 - c|a_n|^{-1}(\rho - 1)^{-1}) = 0$$

QED

This theorem implies a second:

Corollary: If all the roots of $z^n p(1/z)$ are in the disk $B(0, \rho)$, then all the non-zero roots of p are outside $B(0, \rho^{-1})$.

Proof: The polynomial $z^n p(1/z)$ is $s(z) = a_n + a_{n-1}z + ... + a_0 z^n$. Then, $p(z_0) = 0$ is equivalent to $s(1/z_0) = 0$. Since the roots of s have $|z| \leq \rho$, we then have $\frac{1}{|z|} \geq \rho^{-1}$, as desired. *QED*

These results give a starting point for algorithms to take hold. We will focus on Newton's method, but the text also covers Bairstow's method and Laguerre iteration. For Newton's method, we want an easy way to comput the polynomial, especially centered at different points or in the nested multiplication form from the first week. For this, we use Horner's method.

Starting with a polynomial $p(z)$ of the above form, we perform an artificial polynomial division to reduce the degree of the polynomial. Since $p(z) - p(z_0)$ has a root at z_0, we may form $q(z) = \frac{p(z)-p(z_0)}{z-z_0}$ a degree $n-1$-polynomial such that $p(z) = p(z_0) + q(z)(z - z_0)$. Horner's method tells us how to compute this $q(z)$ and $p(z_0)$. Let $q(z) = b_{n-1}z^{n-1} + ... + b_0$. Then, using the product relationship $p(z) = p(z_0) + q(z)(z - z_0)$, $a_n = b_{n-1}$, and $a_j + z_0 b_j = b_{j-1}$ for $0 \leq j \leq n-1$. Rewriting this relationship, we have $b_k = a_{k+1} + z_0 a_{k+2}$. We may compute this all the way down to b_0, and if we put in $k = -1$, the value b_{-1} we solve for is actually $p(z_0)$.

One way this helps our algorithms on the computer side is that it allows us to compute $p'(z_0)$ without needed to use symbolic logic in the comuter (i.e. without using the power rule). Using a taylor series on p, we may see

$$p(z) = c_n(z - z_0)^n + ... + c_1(z - z_0) + c_0$$

where $c_1 = p'(z_0)$. Applying Horner's method at z_0 gives $p(z) = (z - z_0)q(z) + c_0$. It then follows that $q(z_0) = p'(z_0)$ from the product rule. Another way to see this is to write

$$p(z) = c_0 + (z - z_0)(c_1 + (z - z_0)(c_2 + ... + (z - z_0)c_n)...)$$

where, aligning with Horner's relationship, $q(z) = (c_1 + (z - z_0)(c_2 + ... + (z - z_0)c_n)...)$. Repeating Horner's method on q then gives the higher Taylor coefficients of p: for $p(z) = (z - z_0)q_0(z) + p(z_0)$ and $q_i(z) = q_{i+1}(z)(z - z_0) + q_i(z_0)$; then $q_k(z_0) = p^{(k)}(z_0)/k!$ and these values are the last value produced in each step of Horner's method.

We may now work on finding roots. In the special case z_0 is a root, our formula is simply $q(z) = \frac{p(z)}{z-z_0}$, so this division merely decreases the degree of p without any added complication. We may apply Newton's method to $p(z)$, computing its values and its derivative's values by Horner's method, then have $p(z) = (z - z_0)q(z)$ and repeat this idea on $q(z)$. In a finite number of steps, we will have fully factored $p(z)$.

The localization methods give us a good starting area, and we may use polynomial coefficients or estimates to get an idea on a radius that implies convergence for Newton's method. We also have the following:

Theorem on Successive Newton Estimates (Bodewig 1946) Let x_k and x_{k+1} be two successive iterates when NEwton's method is applied to a degree n polynomial p. Then, there is a root of p within distance $n|x_k - x_{k+1}|$ of x_k in the complex plane.

Proof Let $r_1, ..., r_n$ be the roots of p. Then, $p(z) = c\prod_{j=1}^{n}(z - r_j)$, and

$$p'(z) = c\sum_{i=1}^{n}\prod_{j\neq i}(z - r_j) = \sum_{i=1}^{n}\frac{p(z)}{z - r_i}$$

We claim that for and z, there is some index j so $|z - r_j| \leq n|p(z)/p'(z)|$. If this were to fail, we would have

$$|z - r_j|^{-1} < \frac{1}{n}|p'(z)/p(z)| = \frac{1}{n}|\sum(z - r_i)^{-1} \leq \frac{1}{n}\sum|z - r_i|^{-1}$$

Since the number on the right is an average, this is impossible. Notice now that $n|x_k - x_{k+1}| = n|-\frac{p(x_k)}{p'(x_k)}|$, so that we have shown root is within this radius of x_k.

QED

This theorem may be useful for your code or HW, and gives us an idea of how to set error bounds.

4.2 Matrix Algebra and Factorizations

In Math 54, we learned several factorizations like diagonalization, LU-factorization, QR-factorization, and Singular Value decomposition. These will be useful in making code and algorithms more efficient, so we review. Let $A \in M(n, \mathbb{R})$, which means A is a $n \times n$ matrix with entries in $\mathbb{R}$. We denote $A = (a_{i,j})$ to say that the $a_{i,j}$ are the entries of A in the i, j positions. We also sometimes denote the rows of A by A_i or the columns by A_j.

Recall that we do many processes like Gaussian elimination, row reduction, and even diagonalization by elementary row operations. These operations include adding rows, interchanging rows, and multiplying rows by a nonzero constant. For each operation, there exists a matrix E so EA is the same as doing the row operation to A. These matrices E are invertible, and their inverse signifies the opposite row operation. Recall that EA and AE may be different, as multiplication is not commutative for matrices. You should review what being an invertible matrix means, how to compute simple inverses, and how invertibility for a square matrix is the same as being injective, surjective, being the product of elementary matrices, or having nonzero determinant. There are some guiding questions on a MAth 54 review doc from my older teaching sites.

We begin with LU-factorization. Recall that L is a lower triangular matrix if all entries strictly below the diagonal are 0, or $l_{i,j} = 0$ for $i < j$. We may similarly have an upper triangular matrix U. These types of matrices are useful for numerical methods because solving $Lx = b$ or $Ux = b$ is quite easy compared to for a standard matrix. For example, consider

$$\begin{bmatrix} a & 0 \\ b & c \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} d_1 \\ d_2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Then, we have $ax_1 = d_1$, so $x_1 = d_1/a_1$. This helps us solve the second equation, $bx_1 + cx_2 = d_2$ then becomes $x_2 = c^{-1}(d_2 - bd_1a_1^{-1})$. For larger matrices, the same recursion applies to simplyifying inverting L.

A square matrix A has an LU factorization if $A = LU$ where L is lower triangular and U is upper triangular. Like many other factorizations, this is not unique: if D is an invertible diagonal matrix, and $A = LU$, then $A = (LD)(D^{-1}U)$ is another LU-factorization. When A is invertible, it is possible to show that all LU factorizations of A are related by such a relationship.

What criteria do we have to imply an LU-factorization exists? Let $B \in M(k)$ be a sub-matrix of A. The leading principal matrices of A are those B where $b_{i,j} = a_{i,j}$ for all i, j, or where B is located in the top left corner of A. If all leading principal matrices of A are invertible, then A has n LU-factorization (the proof of this is semi-long, but should be understood. I will replicate it here at a later date).

We usually compute the LU-factorization by applying row operations to A to get an upper triangular matrix U, then collecting the elementary matrices to what should be a lower triangular matrix for L (if an LU factorization even exists). For example, consider the matrix

$$\begin{bmatrix} 8 & 4 \\ 4 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

By subtracting the half of the first row from the second, we obtain an upper triangular matrix

$$U = \begin{bmatrix} 8 & 4 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

and this elemetary row operation is encoded by $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ -0.5 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$. The inverse of this operation is $L = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0.5 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, and so we have $A = LU$ is an LU-factorization.

A more foolproof way to compute it theoeretically would be to set up systems of equations, but such a method includes exactly the type of problem we are trying to solve. Simplifying this system leads to the special case of Doolittle's factorization, an LU-factorization with $l_{i,i} = 1$ for $i = 1, ..., n$ (depending on your

reference, these may just be nonzero, which is equivalent by the comments above about diagonal matrices). We may then recursively solve for the values of L and U using the equations

$$u_{k,j} = a_{k,j} - \sum_{s=1}^{k-1} l_{k,s} u_{s,j}$$
$$l_{i,k} = \left[a_{i,k} - \sum_{s=1}^{k-1} l_{i,s} u_{s,k} \right] / u_{k,k}$$

Try multiplying out abstract matrices in the 3×3 case to make sense of these equations. You should notice things like the first row of U and the first row of A being the same, and move from there.

Similarly, Crout factorization is an LU-factorization with $u_{i,i} = 1$ for all i, and also has a recursive algorithm for computing the entries of L and U. We also have a decomposition that looks to LU-factorization as orthogonal diagonalization does to diagonalization. Cholesky's factorization is an LU-factorization where $U = L^T$, or $A = LL^T$. Such a factorization exists and is unique if A is a symmetric and positive definite matrix, but may exist in much broader cases.

5 Week 4: Fixed Points and Functional Iteration (3.4)

The generalizations of Newton's method may be posed as a type of function iteration. If we define $F(x) = x - \frac{f(x)}{f'(x)}$, where f is the function we are trying to find a root of, then Newton's method becomes $F(x_n) = x_{n+1}$. This is a useful situation because there is a strong theorem in analysis that helps us find limits in such cases, called the contraction mapping theorem.

This theorem supposes that we have a non-empty complete metric space X, and defines a function $F : X \to X$ to be a contraction if $|F(x) - F(y)| \leq c|x - y|$ where $c \in (0, 1)$. Under this condition, it poses that we have a unique fixed point x^*, i.e. a point where $F(x^*) = x^*$, and the proof of the theorem shows that we may reach such x^* by taking any point y and $F^n(x) = F(F(...F(x)...))$ converges to x^* as $n \to \infty$.

In the context of the Secant method or Newton's method, we then converge to a root if we can pose appropriate F as a contraction. The MVT is often helpful in showing appropriate functions are contractions on the right spaces.

Finally, we care about the rate of convergence. Given F and $x_{n+1} = F(x_n)$, where F is a contraction with fixed point x^*, we trace $e_n = x_n - x^*$. Under suitable assumptions,

$$e_{n+1} = F(x_n) - F(s) = F(s + e_n) - F(s) = e_n F'(s) + \frac{1}{2} e_n^2 F''(s) + ... + \frac{1}{(q-1)!} e_n^{q-1} F^{(q-1)}(s) + \frac{1}{q!} e_n^q F^{(q)}(\zeta_n)$$

so that if s is an order -q root of F, then $e_{n+1} = \frac{1}{q!} e_n^q F^{(q)}(\zeta_n)$ and we have q-order convergence. Try checking the convergence for Newton's method and the Secant method.

Example: Determine the order of convergence of the sequence $x_n = n^{-1/2}$. We should expect linear convergence from normal limit arguments, but let us check using this method. Squaring the terms, we see $x_n^2 = n$, so that $x_n^{-2} + 1 = n + 1 = x_{n+1}^{-2}$. This is to say

$$F(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{\frac{1}{x^2} + 1}} = \frac{x}{\sqrt{1 + x^2}}$$
$$F'(x) = \frac{1 - x^2}{(x^2 + 1)^{3/2}}$$

so that $F'(0) \neq 0$. We expect linear convergence, and this may also be checked directly from the definition of the order of convergence.

5.1 Aitken's Extrapolation Formula

Let $F \in C^1(\mathbb{R})$ be a contraction with fixed point s, and $x_{n+1} = F(x_n)$ defining a sequence converging to that point. Then,

$$s - x_n \approx \frac{\lambda_n}{1-\lambda_n}(x_n - x_{n-1})$$
$$\lambda_n = \frac{x_n - x_{n-1}}{x_{n-1} - x_{n-2}}$$

Aitken's method stipulates that to compute s, starting with x_1, we compute $x_2 = F(x_1)$ and $x_3 = F(x_2)$, then compute x_4 via the above formula. To proceed, we compute $x_n = F(x_{n-1})$ if $n \equiv 1, 2, 3 \mod 4$ and use Aitken's formula for x_{4k}.

6 Week 3: 3 Root finding Algorithms (3.1-3.3)

6.1 Bisection Method

The bisection method starts with a *continuous* function f and an interval $[a, b]$ on which we have $f(a)f(b) < 0$. This is a special assumption to guarantee that we have a root of our function f on $[a, b]$ by the Intermediate Value Theorem.

We then produce $c = \frac{a+b}{2} = a + \frac{b-a}{2}$, the midpoint of the interval. We check whether $f(a)f(c) < 0$, in which case we set $[a_1, b_1] = [a, c]$. In the case $f(a)f(c) > 0$, we know $f(a)f(b) < 0$, so we et $[a_1, b_1] = [c, b]$. Finally, if $f(c) = 0$, we terminate. We repeat this process, producing c_1 and then $[a_2, b_2]$.

This way, each step cuts the interval in half. We use c_n as out approximation of the root. If r is the root we eventually converge to, we know $|c_n - r| \leq \frac{1}{2}|b_n - a_n| \leq 2^{-n}|b - a|$.

6.2 Newton's Method

For Newton's method, we assume that we have a C^2 function f for which we want to find a root. We start with some initial value x_0. Then, we assume there exists some root r, and so we know $0 = f(r) = f(x_0 - e_0)$ where $e_0 = x_0 - r$. Expanding by Taylor's theorem, $0 = f(x_0) - e_n f'(x_0) + ...$, so we approximate $e_0 \approx f(x_0)/f'(x_0)$ and update

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)}$$

at each subsequent step.

This isn't guaranteed to converge for any starting point, but let's look at the case of convergence.

$$e_{n+1} = x_{n+1} - r = x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)} - r = e_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)}$$

Thus, we use that $0 = f(x_n) - e_n f'(x_n) + e_n^2 f''(\zeta_n)/2$ from above to rewrite this as

$$e_{n+1} = \frac{e_n f'(x_n) - f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)} = \frac{1}{2}\frac{f''(\zeta_n)}{f'(x_n)}e_n^2$$

When do we see convergence? We need the $e_n \to 0$ for this, which is okay when this coefficient is bounded. This is a second place where we use the C^2 assumption. Set

$$c(\delta) = \frac{1}{2}\frac{\max_{|x-r|<\delta}|f''(x|)}{\min_{|x-r|<\delta}|f'(x)|}$$

Using continuity, take δ small enough so $\delta c(\delta) < 1$. Then, it is easy to note that if $|e_n| \leq \delta$, then $|e_{n+1}| \leq \delta$ as well and that $|e_{n+1}| \leq C|e_n|^2$, so that we have quadratic convergence when x_0 is chosen within a δ-ball of r.

6.3 Alternatives to Newton's method

In cases where we don't want to compute the derivative, several alternatives exist. The first approximation we might take is that $f'(x) \approx \frac{f(x+h)-f(x)}{h}$ for small h. Using this in Newton's method gives the Secant method,

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{(f(x_n) - f(x_{n-1}))/(x_n - x_{n-1})}$$

though several alternatives exist, including Steffenson's method (further approximation) and Halley's method (which requires the second derivative). We will explore their convergence rates through functional iteration next week.

7 Week 2: Floating Point Numbers and Machine Numbers (Ch. 2)

-Incomplete.

It would be amazing if we could punch numbers into computers and store exact values, but out computers only have finite memory and numbers like π that are irrational can't be stored in a finite number of base-10 digits. Furthermore, the hardware restrictions of semiconductors when computers were developed means that base-10 is not even natural to create mechanically. For these reasons, we instead store numbers in a finite string of 0s and 1s called bits, which represent a rounded version of the value. This type if storage is called floating point storage, and it can cause some issues if we aren't careful.

First, we represent numbers in scientific notation: $x = (-1)^s r \times 10^n$ where $r \in [0.1, 1)$ and n is an integer. This gives a way to store a spread of values in a consistent way. In binary, this would be of the form $x = (-1)^s q \times 2^m$. The number q is called the mantissa, and m is called the exponent. Since $q \in [1/2, 1)$, we always have a leading 1, so we actually shift the mantissa over by one digit to squeeze more precision out of the same number of bits. Since we want to store both large and very small numbers without needing an extra negative sign for the exponent (which takes extra storage), we also bias the exponent

$$x = (-1)^s 1.f \times 2^{e-127}$$

This is called a normalized floating point form, and is also the IEEE standard floating point representation.

Then, $s \in \{0, 1\}$ will always account for at most 1 bit. The other numbers f and e have lengths depending on the system. In a standard 32-bit system, f recieves 23 bits and e recieves 8 bits.

Numbers of exactly this form are called machine numbers. Some very simple decimal numbers are not machine numbers, such as 0.01. In such cases, most machines round a number to its nearest machine number (though there are other rounding systems in use). In practice, this means we compute the number x in binary to some accuracy, then truncate the expansion to get a machine number just below it, x_1. We also look at the next machine number above x_-, x_+. When the check which is smaller between $x_+ - x$ and $x - x_-$ to determine the machine number.

When arithmetic is done, the computer adds bits to make for accurate calculations. The standard for a 32-bit storage is 80 bits for internal calculations (check out the IEEE standards for more info).

[Overflow, Underflow]

[Error Analysis]

[Absolute and Relative Errors, Loss of Significance, Subtraction fo Nearby Quantities, Accuracy Theorem]

[Stability, Instability, Conditioning Number]

8 Week 1: Calculus Review (1)

- Add IVT, MVT, Taylor's Theorem
- Add Orders of Convergence, big and little O notation, MVT for integrals, nested multiplication